Announcements A3 - Big Data Processing

=== A3 Group Formation Reminder: A3 groups will be locked at 11:59 PM on 22 October. (2026-10-20) ===
Hi all,

Please make sure you have joined the correct pre-created A3 group before the deadline.

Please do not use your A1 or A2 group for this assessment. You may keep the same team members, but you must join an A3 group. Students who choose to complete the assessment collaboratively but fail to correctly form their group before the submission deadline will receive a 10% penalty (2.5 marks).

If you are completing A3 individually, you do not need to join a group. Groups are intended for collaborative work only. Students who complete and submit the assessment individually but join a group will also receive a 10% penalty (2.5 marks).

Please check your group membership carefully before 11:59 PM on 22 October. After the groups are locked, changes to group membership will no longer be permitted.

Regards,

COSC2633/2637 Teaching Team

=== Final reminder: Assessment Extension Applications for A3 (2026-10-19) ===
Dear Students,

This is the final reminder that Assignment 3 (A3) is due on 25 October.

Under the University's one working day extension policy, extension requests must be submitted with sufficient time for staff to review and process them before the assessment due date. The policy still applies regardless of when a request is submitted, and staff are not expected to accept or review requests received outside of the required timeframe.

As a result, extension applications submitted after 22 October will be denied, as there will not be sufficient time to grant and process a one working day extension before the A3 due date.

Weeks 11-13 are generally the busiest period of the semester for all students, with multiple assessment deadlines and other academic commitments occurring during this time. Assessment deadlines are set in advance, and students are expected to plan their workload accordingly.

According to the assignment specification, academic workload and time management, including multiple assignments due in the same week, general study pressure or heavy workload, poor time management or starting late, and underestimating the difficulty of the assignment, are not grounds for an extension.

If you believe you are eligible for an extension, please ensure that your application and any supporting documentation are submitted no later than 22 October.

Please do not wait until the last minute to submit your request.

Thank you for your understanding.

COSC2633/2637 Teaching Team

=== A3 Group Reminder for ***Students Working in Pairs*** (2026-10-16) ===
Hi all,

If you are working in a pair (a group of 2) for A3 and you do not want another student to join your group without your permission, please let me know (ying.zhang3@rmit.edu.au).

I can lock the group for you so that no additional students can join.

Please make sure both intended group members have already joined the correct A3 group before asking for it to be locked.

Regards,

Ying

=== A3 FAQs udpated. (2026-10-16) ===
Hi all,

The A3 FAQs have been updated with additional clarifications based on recent student questions.

https://rmit.instructure.com/courses/158408/discussion_topics/3179024

Please make sure you review the latest FAQs before completing and submitting your A3 work, as they may help clarify some of the common issues and requirements.

The marking script will be developed based on the assignment specification, so please make sure you follow the specification carefully, including all required input formats, output formats, file paths, naming conventions, and processing requirements.

Have a nice weekend,

Ying

=== Assessment Extension Applications for A3 (2026-10-15) ===
Dear Students,

This is a reminder that Assignment 3 (A3) is due on 25 October.

Under the University's one working day extension policy, extension requests must be submitted with sufficient time for staff to review and process them before the assessment due date. The policy still applies regardless of when a request is submitted, and staff are not expected to accept or review requests received outside of the required timeframe.

As a result, extension applications submitted after 22 October will be denied, as there will not be sufficient time to grant and process a one working day extension before the A3 due date.

If you believe you are eligible for an extension, please ensure that your application and any supporting documentation are submitted no later than 22 October.

Please do not wait until the last minute to submit your request.

Thank you for your understanding.

COSC2633/2637 Teaching Team

=== A3 Appendix A - Sample Output Updated (2026-10-05) ===
Hi everyone,

Appendix A - Sample Input and Output has been updated.

The revised examples now include updated sample outputs for Task 1, Task 2, and Task 3, including multiple micro-batches.

Please also note that the sample output is now shown using the corresponding HDFS command, for example:

hadoop fs -cat /output/task1-001/*

hadoop fs -cat /output/task2-001/*

hadoop fs -cat /output/task3-001/*

Please make sure you refer to the latest version of the assessment specification and use the updated Appendix A when checking both your output format and the HDFS output generated by your implementation.

Regards,

COSC2633/2637 Teaching Team

=== A3 Group Formation and Collaboration Expectations (2026-09-30) ===
Hi everyone,

A reminder about A3 group formation and collaboration requirements.

If you are completing A3 as a group, please join one of the pre-created A3 groups in Canvas. Do not create a new group and do not rename any existing group. You may keep the same team members as A1 or A2, but you must join an A3 group.

For the group work itself, each group member is expected to develop their own complete solution to the task first. The group should then compare the individual solutions, discuss the different approaches, and decide on the best final solution to submit. The intention is that every member understands and attempts the full task, rather than dividing the task into separate parts and having each person work on only one section.

Please make sure your work log clearly reflects each member's individual attempt and contribution to the final group solution.

Regards,

COSC2633/2637 Teaching Team

=== A3 is now released. (2026-09-28) ===
Hi everyone,

A3 has now been released on Canvas.

If you are completing A3 as a group, please follow these steps carefully:

- Navigate to People in Canvas, then select the Groups tab. Scroll past the A1 and A2 groups until you reach the A3 group section.

- Choose an empty A3 group and join it together with your group members.

- Do not use your A1 or A2 group for this assessment. You may keep the same team members, but you must join an A3 group.

Please note that:

- You are not permitted to create new groups or rename existing groups. Student-created groups are not linked to the grading system and therefore cannot be correctly identified during marking.

- Canvas groups are intended only for students completing the assessment in groups of two or three. If you are completing A3 individually, you do not need to join a Canvas group.

Please make sure your A3 group is set up correctly before 11:59pm 22/10.

We will walk through the A3 specification in the Week 11 tutorial class if time allows.

Regards,COSC2633/2637 Teaching Team